

THE HIGHEST  
POSSIBLE WAGE

*Charles*

With the Compliments of

J. Kandleberger

Dr. F. W. B. S.



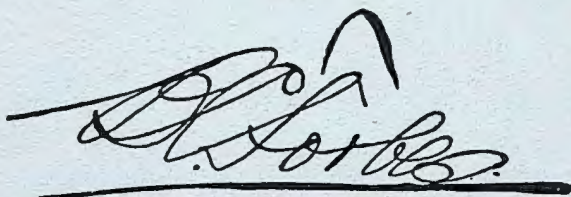
IT'S A WONDERFUL SENSATION WHILE IT LASTS—  
BUT OH, THE AWAKENING!

# The Highest Possible Wage

AND

## How To Attain It

BY

A large, stylized handwritten signature in black ink, which appears to read 'B. C. Forbes'. The signature is written over a horizontal line.

*Editor, "Forbes Magazine"*

*Author, "Men Who Are Making America;" "Keys To Success;" "Forbes Epigrams;" "Finance, Business and the Business of Life."*



NEW YORK  
B. C. FORBES PUBLISHING CO., INC.  
120 FIFTH AVENUE

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THE HIGHEST POSSIBLE WAGE  
AND  
HOW TO ATTAIN IT

# THE HIGHEST POSSIBLE WAGE

## HOW TO EARN IT

IT IS human nature, we are told, to try to get as much as possible for as little as possible. Therefore, it is natural for workers to want high wages.

It is not only natural, it is commendable.

America has progressed, industrially, faster and farther than any other nation partly because our wage-earners have persistently sought better and better pay.

And they have received better and better pay.

In the middle of the thirteenth century (in 1250) building trade laborers in London were paid 3 1/2 cents a day.

In China, wages today amount only to cents.

In the United States wages are higher than in any other country in the world.

Why?

Our continent has been endowed by Nature with vast resources of developable wealth; we have produced more industrial, mining, railway and financial pioneers of tremendous courage, ability and aggressiveness than any other nation; we have harnessed science to actualities; we have developed industrial managers of the highest order,

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men who have led the world in inventing and evolving practical, economical, efficient methods for large-scale, mass production in manufacturing and other plants of greater magnitude than any ever before known; we have reared railroad builders who have given us by far the greatest network of transportation lines in the world; we have produced far-seeing business giants who have gone forth and opened up world markets for American merchandise; and, not least, we have bred a race of capable, intelligent, ambitious workmen, blessed with more congenial working conditions and better living conditions than exist in any other industrial land on the face of the earth.

Our automobile giants, our oil giants, our inventors, our harvesting machinery giants, our steel giants, our sewing machine, typewriter, cash register, photograph apparatus, electrical, rubber, tobacco and other giants, have each contributed invaluablely to raising America to world leadership, to enabling this country to hold its own, and more than hold its own, in world trade and world competition.

Yes, we have been signally blessed by material resources and by men capable of harnessing them to the service of mankind.

For many years, too, we were blessed with an unusually large measure of industrial, of labor peace.

Thus the nation grew and prospered until the United States became the greatest industrial commonwealth on the face of the earth.

But the change from a land of pioneers and farmers to a country of specialized manufacturers and specialized workers brought a change in the relationship between employer and employee.

Just as there had been and still are leaders in industry, leaders arose among workers.

They chose as their slogan, "in union there is strength," and they proceeded to form unions to adjust differences, to better conditions and to gain a larger share of the profits their skill and industry helped to earn.

By and by it became clear, however, that leadership had often been captured, not by workers who were able and anxious to reason soundly and deal fairly, but by those who could talk most glibly.

Every age brings its false prophets. The reasoning of the false prophet sounds so convincing, his promises are so alluring, that many are fooled, deluded into swallowing as gospel truth statements which even those who make them know well are untrue and unsound.

Whether the thing preached by the false prophets was Bolshevism or Socialism or Sovietism or Syndicalism or what-not "ism," the intention of it always was to make workmen believe they could get something for nothing, that they could live luxurious lives without working hard, that revolution would bring Paradise on earth, that if "capital" could only be destroyed, everything would be beautiful and delightful and prosperous, and everybody would be supremely happy.

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Unfortunately, a great many workmen were fooled into swallowing this kind of talk, exactly the kind of talk which was used by the Soviet leaders in Russia to bring about the establishment of Communism in that land, with consequences we now all know, consequences which have brought millions of violent murders by Soviet decree and more millions of deaths through starvation.

All American workmen were not able to see through the hollowness and falseness of such poisonous agitation as clearly as one American workman saw through it and who recently said this in the published story of his life:

"This generation is rich because the preceding generation stored up lots of capital. We are living in the houses and using the railroads that our fathers built by working overtime.

"When labor loafes on the job it makes itself poor. We are not building fast enough to keep ourselves housed. Were it not for the houses our fathers built this generation would be out-of-doors right now, with no roof but the sky.

"No matter who owns the capital, capital works for everybody. Ford owns the flivver factory, but everybody owns the flivvers. The oil king owns the gasoline, but he has to tote it to the roadside where every one can get it. Equal division is the goal that capitalism constantly approaches. No man wants all the gasoline. He wants six gallons at a time, with a service station every few miles. Capital performs this service for him. Under "capitalism," so-called wealth is more equally di-

vided than under any other system ever known.

"Work is a blessing, not a curse. This country had the good luck to be settled by the hardest workers in the world. Their big production made us rich. If we slacken production we will soon be poor. The Indians owned everything in common. They did not work. And they were so poor that this whole continent would support less than two million of them. Thousands of Indians used to starve and freeze to death every hard winter.

"The white man who doesn't want to work is sick. He needs a dose of medicine, not a dose of the millennium.

"When labor loafes, it injures labor first and capital last. For labor grows poor today while the capitalist gets poor tomorrow. But tomorrow never comes.

"'There is enough already created to supply everybody if it were equally divided.' Yes. And there is enough ice at the North Pole to cool off the Sahara Desert if it were equally divided.

"The time to quit work and divide the wealth is just two weeks before the end of the world. For the world's surplus of supplies is just two weeks ahead of starvation."

The American workman who wrote that also wrote this:

"Cold weather and crop failure are not the only things that could bring a famine in America. Slacking in production has the same effect as crop failure. A farmers' strike could bring a famine. A railroad strike could do the same. Many men

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advocate a combination farmers' strike and railroad strike to destroy capital (that is, to destroy the food supply). Don't get impatient, boys. You shall have your famine, if you wait long enough. And the less work you do while you are waiting, the sooner it will come. Nature is never whipped. Nature will take a crack at you, if you leave an opening. The generation that went before you worked ten to fourteen hours a day; they battled face to face with a raw continent in their fight with Nature. And by their muscle they drove Nature back and she surrendered.

"Who are the propagandists that Nature is using to undermine the race that conquered her? Communists, slackers, sick men and fools. The man who says let us 'quit work and divide our cake and eat it' is opening the way for Nature to strike suddenly with a famine. The man who advocates 'one big strike' to destroy our capital is the secret agent of starvation. Nature when up in arms can sweep men off like flies. She has always done it and she always will, unless man uses his intelligence and his cooperation to fight the evils in Nature and not to fight his fellow men.

"'Capitalism,' as the communists call it, is an imperfect system. But it is the only system that has banished famine. Under communism and feudalism there was hunger. Under capitalists the world has been able to feed twice as many mouths as could be fed before."

The American workman, a steel mill worker, who wrote that is today labor's representative in

President Harding's Cabinet, Secretary of Labor Davis. These are bits from his intensely interesting and illuminating life-story, "The Iron Puddler."

As was to be expected, there were enough level-headed, clear-thinking, honorably-intentioned workmen in the land to prevent Bolshevism or any other disaster-breeding "ism" from making any seriously alarming headway here.

But while there never was grave danger that the economic system which has raised America to the front rank among nations would be shortsightedly torn down, the poisonous propaganda did, to some extent, penetrate the minds of many workers and cause them to form false ideas about "capitalism," about production, about labor, and especially about the rate of wages that could and should be paid. One notion which became very widely believed was that the only reason wages in general were not very greatly increased was because employers were a selfish, stingy, mercenary, money-grabbing, callous-hearted lot, and that if they could only be induced to change their attitude, everybody could be and would be paid far more generous wages and enjoy many more of the comforts, the conveniences and luxuries of life.

Now, just what is the real truth about the amount of wages, the highest possible wages that can be paid?

We have been hearing and reading a great deal lately about the "living wage," the "saving wage," the "minimum wage," and other kinds of wages.

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Much can be said concerning the advisability of all these brands of wages. Incidentally, the very fact that we have in this country thirty million savings accounts in savings banks and other institutions, with total savings of more than \$18,000,000,000, proves that a vast number of workers have been getting not merely a "minimum wage" or a "living wage," but a "*saving wage*," since they have been able to live and to save.

That, however, is by the way.

When you go down to the very bottom of the whole matter you discover a very simple and very complete answer to the question of what is the highest wage that can be paid.

What *is* the very highest wage that can be paid?

*The wage that is earned. The earned wage.*

You see that for yourself, don't you, when you give the matter earnest thought?

It becomes very, very plain, doesn't it, that unless high wages are earned, high wages cannot be paid, cannot go on being paid for any length of time.

You know yourself that if you don't pull in more than, say, twenty dollars, you can't possibly pay out more than twenty dollars.

This leads to another question, namely:

How much wages can be earned?

Every man's wage-earning capacity is different.

Take, for example, Secretary of Labor Davis. He gets \$12,000 a year. You will admit, I am sure, that he earns every penny of this.

Next take the man who is making more money than any other human being in the world today,



NOT WHAT HE EXPECTED TO CATCH

Henry Ford. He has been making probably between \$50,000,000 and \$75,000,000 a year for some time. Yet is it not generally admitted that Ford honestly *earns* all that he gets?

Suppose one of Ford's keen-brained employees saw how one dollar could be saved in the making of the Ford car without reducing the usefulness of the car, his idea, if put into practice, would save Ford more than a million dollars in one year. Would not such a man be entitled to receive a very generous income from Ford? Would he not have actually *earned* big pay?

The highest salary I have ever known of was paid by a very large automobile manufacturer to one of his men. This manufacturer told me that this man earned more than half his year's pay in the first two months by making two changes in the process of producing the company's cars. The manufacturer figured that this man was the most profitable employee on his payroll.

I once, when a reporter, worked alongside a graduate of Oxford University, one of the two foremost universities in the world, but he couldn't hold down a twenty-five-dollar-a-week job, although he really worked conscientiously and industriously. Apparently he didn't have it in him.

On the other hand, Samuel Gompers, although given little or no schooling before he became a cigar-maker, developed a big earning capacity as a labor leader, and no one begrudges him his fine income.

Warren S. Stone, president of the Brotherhood of Locomotive Engineers, is said to get, as a side-line,

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\$25,000 a year as president of labor's bank in Cleveland; and, judging by the progress made by the institution, he is well worth this wage; *he is earning it.*

That, let me repeat, is the great point.

Employers can afford to pay the *earned* wage.

They cannot afford to pay more.

They *couldn't pay more*—and go on paying more—no matter how eager they were to do so.

Just like ourselves, employers cannot pay out more than they take in.

There must be income before there is outgo.

You cannot pour milk out of an empty bottle nor squeeze water out of a dry sponge.

Nor can you extract a quart from a pint measure.

It simply can't be done. It isn't in the cards.

In exactly the same way high wages can't be paid if only low wages are earned.

Wages can't be paid out of empty safes or tills.

Wage money can't be drawn out of the air by some miracle.

Before cash can be put into wage envelopes it must first be drawn in by the wage-payer.

How much can be paid out is regulated by how much is pulled in.

A company's income is governed mainly by its workers' output.

Let me make clear these simple truths by a few homely illustrations.

In quite a few concerns workers establish Christmas funds. Every week each member of the fund contributes a certain amount. When

Christmas comes round the workers know that how much they will get out of the fund depends entirely upon how much they had paid in. If they had paid in a lot, they expect to draw a lot; if they had paid in only a little, they know they will receive in return only a little.

I used to live in South Africa. Certain territories were occupied by negroes. They were a lazy, improvident lot. They tilled only a small patch of land. They produced extremely little. But they were sensible enough to realize that, as a result, they would harvest very little. They didn't fool themselves that if they planted only a tiny patch they would reap as much as if they had planted an acre. In their own elementary way, they well knew that, as they sowed, so would they reap. And I never heard any of them complain that this was unfair. As a lad I used to set type in Scotland. I received, at one time, a wage of \$1 a week, but as I set a good deal more than was expected of me, my boss was quite willing to raise my pay to \$1.25 a week. He could afford to pay me this increased amount because I was earning it and something more.

Employers cannot give workers or anyone else that which they don't have, any more than you or I can give what we don't possess.

Even John D. Rockefeller's entire fortune wouldn't pay the wages of our railroads *for four months!*

Do you know that the United States Steel Corporation hasn't enough cash in its treasury to pay its wage bill for three months?

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How much workers can get is governed by how much they earn.

That's the naked truth of the whole matter in the long run.

Suppose Ford's workers decided to soldier on the job; although Ford is the richest man active in business in America today, he wouldn't long be able to pay the present rate of wages and keep on building new plants to give employment to larger and still larger numbers of work people. If they carried the soldiering far enough Ford would go broke.

Why are Ford and the majority of American employers able to pay the highest wages obtainable in the world today?

Among other reasons, because American employers have exercised more skill and enterprise and energy and progressiveness and daring than the employers of other countries in perfecting labor-saving machinery, in organizing large-quantity production, and in spending the millions necessary to build enormous plants and equip them with the best and costliest machines and tools and processes ever devised.

Also, because American workmen, man for man, are not excelled by the workmen of any other land — at least, American workmen were not excelled in the days before there were any labor mis-leaders urging them to keep down output per man.

But even the most aggressive and progressive of employers, helped by the brainiest of executives and managers, will not be able to keep American wages the highest in the world if the majority of

workers should be misled into adopting the idea that curtailed output per man is best and the most profitable for the workers, in the mistaken belief that this will "make more jobs" and that the more jobs there are, the greater will be the demand for workers, thus forcing up the amount of wages paid, in dollars. If such false reasoning were swallowed and acted upon all round, America would be drawn down to the very depths of depression, with unemployment worse than we have ever before known.

As a matter of fact, there is reason for believing that it has been swallowed and acted upon, to at least some extent, in a few lines of industry.

The authorities found, for example, that when the railway employees had the whip hand during the war period when William G. McAdoo (who later was among those in the running for the Presidential nomination) was acting as Director-General, they enforced various rules and regulations which "made work" unnecessarily and compelled the management to employ this, that and the next classification of worker to do each little part of a tin-pot repairing job which any ordinary American mechanic could do by himself in short order.

Again, why are you and I compelled to pay such high rents?

Partly because of the serious scarcity of houses brought about by the war-time conditions; partly because of the high prices for lumber, brick and certain other building materials.

Yes.

But partly, also, because of the way you and I

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have been treated by those who do the work of building houses.

Certain classes of building tradesmen have not only forced us all to pay high rents in order to pay them higher wages than most other workers get themselves, but it has been brought out through investigations by Samuel Untermyer and others acting in an official capacity that building trade unions have framed and enforced rules which needlessly added to the cost of erecting houses for us, and, perhaps worse still, encouraged soldiering on the job.

Read these charges against the plumbers made publicly by the Association of Master Plumbers:

Refusing to permit each plumber to have a helper; refusing pipe cutting by machine and refusing to allow the cutting where it could be done quicker and cheaper in the shop or at the factory instead of on the job; refusing to recognize the cards of union men coming from other sections, although belonging to the same union; barring apprentices and refusing to allow helpers to handle tools, which prevents them from learning the trade.

It's easy enough to figure that if building tradesmen, by soldiering on the job, by continuing to force wages above the rate paid other classes of workers, or by unfair and shortsighted working rules, send up the cost of erecting a home, say, \$2,000, then the man who pays for that home must charge *extra* rent so as to net him interest on that additional \$2,000. Six per cent. interest on \$2,000, means \$120 a year added to the rent.

That comes to \$10 a month — no small item for the average head of a family who has to pay the rent bill.

Nor is that all.

Excessively high building costs discourage the putting up of homes.

And the fewer homes built, the more acute the scarcity, the keener the competition for accommodations.

And the keener the competition for accommodations, the higher are rents forced up.

That is plain enough, isn't it?

It amounts just to this: Soldiering on the job, limiting output per man, enforcing unnecessary rules which swell costs, all mean dearer homes; this reduces the number of homes built; and both together send up the amount of rent you and I and other workers have to pay.

Dearness and scarcity, in others words, mean a small supply.

And insufficient supply forces us to do with less.

Now, the same thing applies to all other necessities of life:

*The less produced, the less there is to go round.*

And the less there is to go round, the less each can afford to procure — at least, the less those of us who are not rich can afford.

Let us liken the nation or the world to a family of, say, ten children all growing up. If most of the children are not able to produce very much, or earn very much, then the family will have only a certain amount of life's necessities and comforts. But if the children, as they grow up, develop

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greater capacity for producing or earning, then the family will have more to go round. If all work reasonably hard and industriously and intelligently, they will all be able to enjoy more necessities and comforts and luxuries than if some of the members loafed on the job or worked only when they felt like it or worked only half-heartedly and indolently when they did work.

The more this family produced or earned, the better off it would be, the greater its plentifulness.

Is not that plain enough?

Well, it is the same with a nation as a whole.

If the people of any land become lazy, indifferent, inefficient, then they produce less and there is less to go round.

And which class suffers most?

Why, the less wealthy class, of course; meaning the rank and file of workers.

Therefore, by *doing* as little as possible, the working classes must suffer through having to do *with* as little as possible.

The Bible laid down this decree: "If any man would not work, neither should he eat."

In the same way, if the working people work little, they will have little to eat and wear, little comfort in their homes, little recreation, little education, little, in short, of the good things of life.

Scarcity always sends the price up.

And the people who can least afford to pay fancy prices are those who earn the least.

Hence, the worst sufferers are not merely those who do the soldiering on the job, but other workers, all other workers.

Loafers and shirkers are like drones in a hive.

They live off what the other bees, the real workers, produce.

But bees in some respects have more sense than human beings. The working bees promptly drive out the drones and enforce the Biblical injunction very effectively: they simply kill the drones.

"A man's foes shall be they of his own household," says the Book of Wisdom.

Two of labor's worst foes are in its own household: the unwise leader who incites workers to produce less and less and to clamor for more and more; and the slacker, the soldierer, who doesn't produce his fair share but wants to consume as much as the decent, industrious worker who produces his full share.

If *all* were to produce little, there naturally would be little to enjoy, to consume.

If the people of a nation are indolent, ignorant, unprogressive, they reap the fruits of indolence, ignorance and backwardness.

Where the people of a nation are industrious, intelligent, progressive, they are relatively prosperous.

In the first instance there isn't very much produced. In the second instance a great deal is produced.

Therefore, in the one case there is little to divide. In the second there is a lot to divide.

You can't divide 100 into 100 parts and give each two.

It all gets down to this:

The workers of any nation can never hope to

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receive year-in, year-out more than they earn.

If they don't earn "a saving wage," they can't permanently receive a "saving wage."

If they don't earn a "living wage," they can't go on receiving enough to enable them to live on the scale implied by the term a "living wage."

Charles P. Steinmetz, the famous electrical engineer who was a Socialist candidate at the November elections (1922) and who cannot be accused, therefore, of undue friendliness to "capital," lays down this truth:

"Industry must yield to capital a fair return or it cannot survive."

Not only so, but workers must produce a fair output or they cannot live in anything like reasonable comfort, no matter how keenly the employers might desire to pay workers high wages.

We saw how this worked out during the war.

So large a number of the people in America and other countries were engaged in producing things for use in the war that there was not produced a normal quantity of things for use in peace.

Houses became scarce. Food became scarce. Clothing became scarce. Coal became scarce. Almost everything else became scarce.

And only one thing could happen, the thing that did happen: *Prices soared.*

The time came when prices, because of scarcity, because of under-production, went beyond the reach of the majority of ordinary households.

After a lot of pinching and hardship and suffer-

ing, the memorable "buyers' strike" occurred.

Mind you, the "buyers' strike" was not declared merely because the people objected to high prices.

The "strike" developed because a very, very large number of families didn't have enough money to pay the prices asked.

When normal buying ceased, several millions of workers were thrown idle.

It wasn't until prices had fallen substantially that the consumers began to resume buying in normal volume.

In order to get prices down to a level that would attract buying, wages were lowered in many lines.

The thing most certain to wreck prosperity is slacking by workers — under-production — as this leads to light supplies of life's necessities and comforts, and light supplies naturally lead to rising prices.

And when prices reach a certain height, the whole unsound house of cards collapses.

That plunges labor into widespread, serious unemployment, and precipitates heavy, crippling losses in the industrial and business world.

We thus suffer hard times all round.

Over-reaching never pays in the long run.

Any leader who urges the worker not to "kill the job" by doing a full day's work is in reality doing his best to kill that job and every other job, to kill prosperity everywhere — except for the fellows who serve dispossess notices and the bankruptcy court lawyers and attendants.

The manufacturer or the merchant who does

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not give full value for the money he gets doesn't prosper for very long. In time he suffers for his sharp practices, for his shortsightedness.

So it is with workers, with individual workers and with workers as a whole.

Who are the first workers to be let go?

The fellows who the boss knows to be the poorest producers, the worst shirkers, the fellows who yield no profit to their employer.

It wouldn't matter how strongly workers were organized, it wouldn't matter if all workers in the land were organized into "one big union," if they didn't *earn* high wages, they couldn't, by hook or by crook or by any other means or method or device, go on collecting more pay than they earned.

If they produced less goods than were formerly produced, they would not be able to procure as much or as many goods as before.

If there was less to divide, it stands to reason that all couldn't get as much as formerly, no matter how high the wage rate might be marked up in dollars. (Consider Russia.)

The recipe for prosperity for workmen and for us all — we are all workers — is not less work but more work, not more spending but more saving, not higher prices but lower prices, not more extravagance but more economy, not riotous living but right living.

Employers — representing capital — must play their part honorably and ably.

Management must possess and exercise ability and efficiency.

Both have grave responsibilities.

We could not prosper without either.

Much could be written on their duties, on their part in the scheme of things.

But the subject of this attempt to spread a little helpful enlightenment is wages, the aim being to make clear to all that the only wage that can be paid, the highest wage than can possibly be paid is the *earned* wage, the wage that is earned, *that* and not a dollar more.

The more earned by workers, the more they can be and will be paid.

The less they earn, the less they will be, can be paid.

How much and how many of the good things of life there is for all depends in no small degree upon how much workers work, upon how much they produce.

That which is not produced cannot be distributed, cannot be enjoyed.

That which is produced *is* distributed, *is* enjoyed.

The more there is for all, the more all will have.

Whether we all shall have much or little depends upon whether we all work the best we possibly can or do the least we can get by with.

# IMPORTANCE OF THIS SUBJECT

BY GEORGE W. HINMAN

B. C. Forbes of New York announces that he will publish a series of articles on this subject:

"What is the highest possible wage?"

Mr. Forbes is well known to readers of many newspapers. He could have selected no other question to answer that is at once so practical and so urgent in this country's business.

What is the highest possible wage? This is the question that puts the twister into all matters of high or low prices, high or low cost of living and high or low prices of securities, not only for the workers themselves, but for all the rest of 110,000,000 Americans.

About 40,000,000 persons in the United States work for salaries every year. The yearly income of the nation is about \$40,000,000,000. That is a rather high estimate, but there is authority for it.

billions were to every worker \$1,000 a year. enough. But it is as it looks.

lies there is more Therefore the average among the workers is figured about \$1,400 a year.

*Mr. Hinman is editor of the Chicago Herald-Examiner and a recognized authority on economic subjects. What he says here was originally published in a large number of newspapers dotting the whole country.*

year. The yearly nation is about That is a rather there is authority

So, if the forty be evenly divided, would get about

That looks bad not quite so bad

In many families more than one worker. average family income and salary commonly at

At present that is the limit—not the limit of what the workers want, not the limit of what every well-disposed man would have them get, but the limit of what, on the average, they can get as long as the nation's income is no larger than it is now.

But surely many workers get more than \$1,000 a year each. We hear daily of coal miners that make eight or ten dollars a day, plasterers that in Chicago received twenty dollars a day, and so on.

True enough, but for every man earning so much above the average in selected employments there are many men and women, especially in rural communities, who are getting much less.

The \$40,000,000,000 income of the United States is like a blanket at which all workers are pulling and hauling to get the largest share for themselves.

Some get more than others, and whenever some get more others get less, for the blanket is just a \$40,000,000,000

blanket and is not made larger by all the pulling and hauling in the world.

In a word, wages and salaries as a whole cannot be put up unless the nation's income is put up.

A strike may secure for a certain group of workers more than their share; but other workers then have to pay the difference by accepting pay below the average.

But don't such facts justify counsels of despair?

Not at all.

They mean simply that with our growing population and our growing numbers of wage and salary workers we should produce more income, make the blanket larger.

How?

By foreign trade, by domestic development, by the advance of enterprise, by the forward movement of business.

In one year of inflation the nation's income passed \$60,000,000,000. At that figure the average of the worker, if the whole income went to workers, would be around \$1,500 a year. That is the highest average wage that ever has been possible in this country.

So the common talk about \$1,800 or \$2,000 or \$2,200 a year as a general wage is moonshine. Neither the money nor the income is there to give it substance. We only raise false hopes when we talk such figures — sympathetic hopes but false ones.

But suppose that the big incomes of the millionaires were wiped out and the wage workers and salary workers got the benefit.

If all the net incomes above even \$10,000 a year were seized, the present possessors turned out to grass, and the proceeds distributed among the forty and odd millions of wage and salary workers, the gain of each worker would be about \$2.20 a week.

So we come to the final proposition that to divide more among the wage and salary workers, we must have more to divide.

The \$40,000,000,000 cannot be stretched to cover higher wages and salaries on the average than it is now covering.

Unless the nation's income can be pushed up, an increase in the income of one group means a decrease for another group — an injustice that all must deplore.

More national income — that is the only key to unlock the problem of a higher possible wage all around.